

Chittur Delegation to Thiruvananthapuram — 15 July 2026

Delegation: Representatives of the **Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara**, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District, Kerala.

Accompanied by: **Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA** — Chittur (Constituency No. 58), Kerala Legislative Assembly.

Purpose: To submit petitions and request the concerned Ministers to expedite action on five issues affecting the Chittur Assembly constituency, and in particular the rain-shadow panchayats of **Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara**.

Index of Petitions and Ministers to be met

#	Subject	Primary Minister	Copies to
1	Raise the sanctioned agricultural EB connection to 5 HP for deep borewells in the rain-shadow belt	Minister for Electricity (Sunny Joseph)	Minister for Agriculture (T. Siddique); Minister for Water Resources (Mons Joseph)
2	Renewal / review of the Parambikulam-Aliyar Project (PAP) agreement and realisation of Kerala's assured Chitturpuzha share	Minister for Water Resources (Mons Joseph)	Hon'ble Chief Minister (V.D. Satheesan) — holds <i>Inter-State River Waters</i>
3	Dairy processing / cattle-feed / semen-preservation / veterinary college for Chittur and productivity improvement	Minister for Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development (Bindu Krishna)	Minister for Co-operation (M. Liju)
4	Special status / pollution-category parity for the coir (de-fibring & pith) industry in Chittur	Minister for Industries (P.K. Kunhalikutty)	Minister for Coir (Ramesh Chennithala); Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board
5	Simplify fertilizer (urea) procurement for genuine farmers while preventing diversion	Minister for Co-operation (M. Liju)	Minister for Agriculture (T. Siddique); Minister for Food & Civil Supplies (Anoop Jacob)

Note on facts and figures

These drafts were prepared using publicly reported data (Central Ground Water Board, Kerala Ground Water Department, Kerala Irrigation Department / KIIDC, Milma/MRCMPU, CPCB/TNPCB, Department of Fertilizers). A few figures in the original brief were corrected against the record:

- **Rainfall** is measured in **millimetres (mm)**, not centimetres. Chittur's rain-shadow belt gets roughly **≤1,000 mm** a year against Kerala's average of about **3,000 mm** — i.e. about one-third.
- The bottling-plant water controversy referred to is the **Plachimada (Coca-Cola) case in Perumatty panchayat**, Chittur — used here as background to the restrictive groundwater regime.
- **PAP water figures** are stated using documented entitlements (**7.25 TMC / 7,250 mcft** at Manakadavu weir) rather than the "90 / 12.5 TMC" figures in the brief.

Before printing on the Society's letterhead, please fill in the bracketed blanks [. . .] (names, signatories, phone, membership numbers), attach the noted annexures, and, where useful, add a Malayalam translation. Any Government Order (G.O.) numbers should be verified with the MLA's office / department for the latest reference.

The individual petitions are in the numbered files in this folder.

Petition 1 — Enhancement of Agricultural Electricity Connection to 5 HP for Deep Borewells in the Chittur Rain-Shadow Belt

To: Shri Sunny Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Electricity, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Mons Joseph, Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation & Ground Water)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to permit and expedite agricultural electricity connections up to **5 HP** (and, where justified, above 5 HP) for deep irrigation borewells in the rain-shadow panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara and adjoining areas of the Chittur block.

1. Respected Sir,

We are farmer-representatives of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara. We respectfully place before you the acute irrigation-power difficulty faced by the farmers of the eastern, rain-shadow part of the Chittur Assembly constituency, and pray for your intervention.

2. The factual position

- 1. Kerala's driest belt.** Chittur — and in particular Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara — lies in the Palakkad Gap **rain-shadow region**, the driest tract in Kerala. Annual rainfall here is only about **1,000 mm (and often less)**, against the State average of roughly **3,000 mm** — barely **one-third** of the State average. The surrounding hills block the rain-bearing winds.
- 2. A "Critical" groundwater block.** As per the Central Ground Water Board's *National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources of India (2023 and 2024)*, **Chittur is one of only two or three "Critical" groundwater blocks in the entire State of Kerala** (along with Malampuzha and Kasaragod), where the stage of groundwater extraction is between 90% and 100%.
- 3. Deepening borewells.** Because surface water is scarce and rainfall is low, farmers depend almost entirely on borewells. Water tables have fallen steeply — borewells that were once 400-600 ft now increasingly **cross 800-1,000 ft** in these panchayats.
- 4. The power bottleneck.** Following the groundwater regime tightened after the Plachimada (Perumatty panchayat) bottling-plant water controversy and under the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 and Rules, 2004**, an electricity connection to a well/borewell requires a permit from the Ground Water Authority. In practice, agricultural connections in this belt are effectively held at around **3 HP**; the district-level committee sanctions motors only in the **3-5 HP** band, and anything above 5 HP has to go all the way to the **State-level authority**, causing long delays.
- 5. Why 3 HP is not enough.** A 3 HP pump simply cannot lift adequate water from a borewell that is 800-1,000 ft deep. The result is that farms cannot be irrigated even where a valid well exists, causing crop loss and distress among paddy, banana, coconut and vegetable growers who have no alternative source of water.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister to:

1. **Sanction agricultural EB connections up to 5 HP as the norm** for genuine cultivators in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara (and comparable critical-zone areas of Chittur block) where the certified borewell depth exceeds a reasonable threshold (e.g. 500/800 ft), on production of the Ground Water Authority permit.
2. **Expedite and simplify** clearances for connections **above 5 HP** in genuinely deep borewells, on the basis of a well-depth certificate, without routine referral delays.
3. Establish a **single-window** so that the Ground Water Authority permit and the KSEB connection are processed together within a fixed time limit.
4. **Retain the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff** for these enhanced-HP irrigation connections.
5. Consider **dedicated agricultural feeders and solar-pump support (PM-KUSUM / State schemes)** so that the higher connected load does not raise the farmer's cost, and to make deep-borewell irrigation energy-efficient (paired with drip/micro-irrigation).

We are willing to furnish panchayat-wise lists of affected farmers, borewell-depth data and pending connection applications.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Panchayat-wise list of affected farmers and pending/limited connections.
- Annexure B: Borewell depth certificates / sample.
- Annexure C: CGWB categorisation extract for Chittur block.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Petition 2 — Renewal / Review of the Parambikulam-Aliyar Project (PAP) Agreement and Realisation of Kerala's Assured Chitturpuzha Share

To: Shri Mons Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation, CADA & Ground Water), Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: Shri V.D. Satheesan, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Kerala (holding the *Inter-State River Waters* portfolio)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Urgent renewal / review of the Parambikulam-Aliyar Project (PAP) agreement between Kerala and Tamil Nadu, and guaranteed realisation of Kerala's assured water share for the Chitturpuzha valley.

1. Respected Sir,

The single most important lifeline for the farmers of the Chittur rain-shadow belt is the water of the **Chitturpuzha**, a tributary of the Bharathapuzha, fed under the inter-State **Parambikulam-Aliyar Project (PAP)** agreement with Tamil Nadu. We pray for the State's urgent intervention to renew this long-overdue agreement and to secure the water that is rightfully ours.

2. Why Chittur has no alternative

Chittur is the **eastern-most** agricultural tract of Kerala. Almost every river rising in the Western Ghats flows **westward; no west-flowing river can reach** the eastern panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara. Combined with the lowest rainfall in the State (about 1,000 mm against Kerala's ~3,000 mm average), this makes the assured release under the PAP agreement — chiefly through the **Manakadavu weir** into the Chitturpuzha and thence the **Moolathara barrage / Right Bank Canal** — the **only** dependable surface-water source for this region. The waters of the Chittur valley were historically developed to serve the Chittur tract of the erstwhile **Cochin (Kochi) State**; the command that this water must serve has since expanded well beyond that original region.

3. The agreement and its shortfall — the facts

1. **The agreement.** The PAP agreement was signed between Kerala and Tamil Nadu on **29 May 1970**, with retrospective effect from **9 November 1958**.
2. **Renewal is decades overdue.** The agreement contains a clause for **review every 30 years**, i.e. it was **due for review in 1988**. Despite many rounds of official- and political-level talks, it **has still not been renewed** — a delay now of nearly four decades.
3. **Kerala's assured share is not being received.** Under the agreement, Kerala is entitled to about **7,250 million cubic feet ($\approx$ 7.25 TMC)** of water per water year (1 July – 10 June) at the **Manakadavu weir** for the Chitturpuzha, in addition to an entitlement of about **2.5 TMC from the Parambikulam group of reservoirs for the exclusive use of the Chitturpuzha valley**. In practice, actual releases fall far short: - In the **2023-24 water year**, Kerala received **only about 3,573 mcft** (as reported to the Assembly up to January 2024) — roughly **half** the assured 7,250 mcft. - The Kerala Assembly's **1994 ad-hoc committee** recorded that Kerala had received only about **15.9 TMC against a due share of 41.75 TMC**.

4. **Structural cause.** Following the construction of the chain of PAP dams and diversions, the natural flow that once reached the Chitturpuzha valley has been substantially curtailed; assured flows at Manakadavu and Sholayar are not being honoured in low-yield years, and Tamil Nadu has proposed further diversions without Kerala's concurrence.

4. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, and through him the Hon'ble Chief Minister (who holds the Inter-State River Waters portfolio), to:

1. **Accord top priority to the renewal / review of the PAP agreement**, which has been overdue since 1988, and pursue it at the Chief-Minister level with Tamil Nadu.
2. **Insist on full realisation of the assured 7,250 mcft (7.25 TMC) at the Manakadavu weir**, with **telemetry / measuring stations and a transparent monitoring mechanism** to guarantee the flow, especially in the critical summer months and in low-yield years.
3. Press Tamil Nadu to **release water from the Parambikulam reservoir to Aliyar and onward to Manakadavu**, and to honour the **2.5 TMC exclusive Chitturpuzha-valley entitlement**.
4. **Reconstitute and reconvene the joint (secretary-level) Kerala-Tamil Nadu committee**; and, should Tamil Nadu remain unresponsive, examine recourse to a **statutory tribunal / Union Government (Ministry of Jal Shakti) mediation** under the inter-State river-water framework.
5. **Complete and extend the Moolathara Right Bank Canal micro-irrigation project** so that the assured water actually reaches the tail-end fields of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara.

5. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Copy of the 1970 PAP agreement (relevant clauses).
- Annexure B: Year-wise data of assured vs. actual releases at Manakadavu weir.
- Annexure C: Map of the Chitturpuzha command and the eastern panchayats.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Petition 3 — Dairy Processing, Cattle-Feed, Semen-Preservation and Veterinary Education Infrastructure for Chittur, and Measures to Improve Cattle Productivity

To: Smt. Bindu Krishna Hon'ble Minister for Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development and Milk Co-operatives, Government of Kerala (also in charge of the Kerala Veterinary & Animal Sciences University) Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: Shri M. Liju, Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhijampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to establish dairy value-addition / processing, cattle-feed manufacturing, semen-preservation and veterinary-education facilities in the Chittur belt, and to support measures that raise cattle productivity.

1. Respected Madam,

Chittur is among the foremost milk-producing regions of Kerala, yet the dairy-processing and support infrastructure has not kept pace with production. We pray for facilities that will let our dairy farmers capture more value close to home.

2. The factual position

1. **A leading milk region.** Palakkad district — with the Chittur belt as a major contributor — records daily milk collection of the order of **3 lakh litres**, among the highest in the State, sustained by around **30,000 dairy farmers** organised into **300-plus primary dairy co-operative societies**.
2. **Existing capacity is concentrated elsewhere in the district.** The Milma / MRCMPU **Palakkad Dairy at Kallepully** (commissioned 1967) and the **cattle-feed plant at Malampuzha** serve the district, and a straw-baling unit operates at Pattanchery. However, the **eastern Chittur belt (Kozhijampara / Eruthempathy / Vadakarapathy) has little or no dedicated milk-processing / value-addition capacity of its own**, so much of the milk leaves the region as raw milk with limited local value addition.
3. **Missing links.** There is **no dedicated frozen-semen / bull station or semen-preservation and AI-strengthening centre** in the Chittur region, and there is **no Veterinary and Animal Sciences College in Palakkad district** — the Kerala Veterinary & Animal Sciences University (KVASU) campuses are far away (Pookode, Wayanad; Mannuthy, Thrissur). This limits both productivity support to farmers and skilled veterinary manpower locally.

3. Our prayer

Given Chittur's standing as a top milk-producing region, we humbly request that **at least one — and ideally a cluster — of the following be sanctioned for the Chittur belt:**

1. A **modern dairy products / value-addition and processing plant** (curd, ghee, paneer, flavoured milk, milk powder / value-added products), or a major capacity expansion, located in the Chittur belt so that farmers realise better prices locally.
2. A **cattle-feed manufacturing unit** in Chittur, leveraging locally available maize and agricultural residues, to reduce feed cost — the single largest cost in dairying.

3. A **frozen-semen / bull station or semen-preservation and Artificial Insemination (AI) strengthening centre**, with embryo-transfer and sexed-semen facilities, to improve herd genetics.
4. A **Veterinary and Animal Sciences College (KVASU campus)** in Palakkad / Chittur, to provide local veterinary services, extension and skilled manpower.

4. Measures to improve cattle productivity (requested support)

- Promotion of **green-fodder and maize / azolla cultivation** and **Total Mixed Ration (TMR)** in the fodder-scarce, rain-shadow belt, with fodder-development subsidy.
- Wider distribution of **mineral mixture, bypass protein feed** and quality **pellet feed** at subsidised rates.
- **Bulk milk coolers (BMCs)** and chilling points in the eastern panchayats to cut spoilage in the hot climate.
- **High-genetic-merit / sexed semen**, herd-health camps, mastitis control and deworming drives.
- **Cattle insurance** and interest-subvention linked dairy loans through the co-operative sector.

5. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Society-wise milk procurement data for the Chittur belt.
- Annexure B: Proposed site options for the plant / centre.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Petition 4 — Special Status and Pollution-Category Parity for the Coir (De-fibring & Pith) Industry in Chittur

To: Shri P.K. Kunhalikutty Hon'ble Minister for Industries & Commerce, Government of Kerala
Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri Ramesh Chennithala, Hon'ble Minister in charge of Coir 2. The Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request for special status and pollution-category parity for coir de-fibring and coir-pith processing units in Chittur, so that the coir industry can develop within Kerala instead of migrating across the border to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu).

1. Respected Sir,

Chittur adjoins the Pollachi belt of Tamil Nadu and has abundant coconut and coir-husk availability. Yet the primary coir-processing industry has migrated almost entirely to Pollachi, chiefly because of a **difference in pollution-control classification** between the two States. We pray for a level playing field.

2. The factual position

- 1. The classification gap.** The primary coir processes — **coconut-husk retting, de-fibring, and coir-pith processing** — are treated far more stringently by the Kerala State Pollution Control Board (historically in the **Red / Orange** category) than in Tamil Nadu. In **October 2023 the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board withdrew its earlier "Orange" reclassification and retained coir husk-retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the "White" (practically non-polluting) category.**
- 2. The consequence.** Because of this gap, the **polluting / primary processes (de-fibring, pith buffering) are carried out in Pollachi**, while only value-addition (mats, yarn, mattings, geotextiles) is done in Kerala. Coir entrepreneurs — including many from Kerala — have set up primary units in Pollachi, taking away investment, jobs and the value of our own coconut husk.
- 3. CPCB norms actually permit a lighter category.** The Central Pollution Control Board's own methodology and its 2023 draft / 2025 classification place coir at a **much lighter category than Red:** - Coir fibre / pith processing generating effluent — **Green**; - Coir fibre / pith processing and manufacture of coir products by **dry process — White**; - Only coir **bleaching / dyeing / printing — Orange**.

In other words, a blanket Red/Orange treatment of ordinary de-fibring and dry pith processing in Kerala is **stricter than the CPCB norm requires**, and Kerala can align without diluting genuine environmental safeguards.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, in coordination with the Coir portfolio and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board, to:

- 1. Re-align the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing** in Kerala to **Green / White**, consistent with the CPCB 2016 methodology and the 2023/2025 classification, so that such units are viable in Chittur while dyeing/bleaching alone remains regulated.

2. Grant **special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status for Chittur**, with a Special Purpose Vehicle and a **Common Facility Centre** (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing / block-making with **Zero-Liquid-Discharge and effluent / salinity management**), so that environmental concerns are addressed collectively and cost-effectively.
3. Provide **fiscal incentives** — capital subsidy, interest subvention, and **power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu** — to attract coir units to Chittur.
4. Ensure a **level playing field with Pollachi** so that the value addition to Kerala's own coconut husk is retained within Kerala, generating local employment.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Comparative note — KSPCB vs. TNPCB coir classification and CPCB norms.
- Annexure B: Estimated husk availability and employment potential in Chittur.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Petition 5 — Simplify Fertilizer (Urea) Procurement for Genuine Farmers while Preventing Diversion

To: Shri M. Liju Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Anoop Jacob, Hon'ble Minister for Food, Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to simplify the procurement of urea and other subsidised fertilizers for genuine farmers — especially the elderly and tenant cultivators — while strengthening safeguards against diversion to the wrong persons.

1. Respected Sir,

Primary Agricultural Co-operative Societies (PACS) and co-operative outlets are the main channel through which our farmers buy fertilizer. The present procedure, though well-intentioned, has become **burdensome for genuine farmers** while still leaving gaps that allow diversion. We pray for a simpler, safer system.

2. The factual position

- 1. The current procedure.** Under the Union Government's **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) for fertilizers** (in force since 2017–18), all subsidised fertilizers — **urea, DAP, MOP, super-phosphate, etc.** — can be sold only through **Aadhaar-linked Point-of-Sale (PoS) machines with biometric (fingerprint) authentication**, with the buyer identified via Aadhaar / Kisan Credit Card / Voter ID and the sale logged in the integrated fertilizer management system (iFMS).
- 2. The difficulties on the ground.** In Palakkad, farmers report: - **Repeated demands for documents** — Aadhaar, and in practice **land-tax receipts / land records** — at every purchase; - **Fingerprint-authentication failures**, especially for **elderly farmers** and manual labourers; - **Exclusion of tenant / lease cultivators**, who till land they do not own and cannot readily produce land documents; - **Network / technical glitches** at PoS terminals, and problems with small-quantity purchases.
- 3. The genuine concern.** At the same time, safeguards are needed so that subsidised fertilizer is **not diverted** to non-agricultural / industrial use, bulk hoarders, or across the State border to the wrong persons.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister for Co-operation (through whom the PACS network functions), in coordination with Agriculture and Civil Supplies, to:

- 1. Introduce a one-time verified "Farmer ID / registration"** — issued through the PACS and linked once to the farmer's **Aadhaar, land / registered-lease record and Soil Health Card** — so that documents such as land-tax receipts **need not be produced at every purchase**; the PoS simply reads the pre-verified entitlement.
- 2. Permit biometric alternatives** (OTP / face authentication) and allow an **authorised family member or registered nominee** to purchase on behalf of elderly, ill or differently-abled farmers.

3. **Recognise registered tenant / lease cultivators** (through Padasekhara Samithis / lease registers / cultivation certificates from the Krishi Bhavan) so that landless-but-genuine farmers are not excluded.
4. **Do not insist on the land-tax receipt at each sale** once the one-time registration is complete.
5. **Strengthen anti-diversion safeguards** — enforce **crop-wise / area-wise entitlement ceilings** in the PoS / iFMS, flag abnormal or bulk purchases, and audit — so that fertilizer reaches only genuine cultivators and is blocked from wrong persons and cross-border diversion.
6. **Ensure adequate buffer stock and upgraded PoS connectivity** at PACS in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara during the peak sowing season.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Instances of document-related hardship (with dates / outlets).
- Annexure B: List of PACS outlets in the Chittur belt and their PoS status.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur